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Retirement topics - IRA contribution limits

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Note: For other retirement plans contribution limits, see Retirement Topics – Contribution Limits.

For 2026, the total contributions you make each year to all of your traditional IRAs and Roth IRAs can't be more than:

- $7,500 ($8,600 if you're age 50 or older), or
- If less, your taxable compensation for the year

For 2025 and 2024, the total contributions you make each year to all of your traditional IRAs and Roth IRAs can't be more than:

- $7,000 ($8,000 if you're age 50 or older), or
- If less, your taxable compensation for the year

For 2023, the total contributions you make each year to all of your traditional IRAs and Roth IRAs can't be more than:

- $6,500 ($7,500 if you're age 50 or older), or
- If less, your taxable compensation for the year

The IRA contribution limit does not apply to:

- Rollover contributions
- Qualified reservist repayments

Deducting your IRA contribution

Your traditional IRA contributions may be tax-deductible. The deduction may be limited if you or your spouse is covered by a retirement plan at work and your income exceeds certain levels.

- IRA deduction limits

Roth IRA contribution limit

In addition to the general contribution limit that applies to both Roth and traditional IRAs, your Roth IRA contribution may be limited based on your filing status and income.

- 2024 - Amount of Roth IRA Contributions You Can Make for 2024
- 2023 - Amount of Roth IRA Contributions You Can Make for 2023

IRA contributions after age 70½

For 2020 and later, there is no age limit on making regular contributions to traditional or Roth IRAs.

For 2019 and earlier, if you're 70 ½ or older, you can't make a regular contribution to a traditional IRA. However, you can still contribute to a Roth IRA and make rollover contributions to a Roth or traditional IRA regardless of your age.

Spousal IRAs

If you file a joint return, you may be able to contribute to an IRA even if you didn't have taxable compensation as long as your spouse did. Each spouse can make a contribution up to the current limit; however, the total of your combined contributions can't be more than the taxable compensation reported on your joint return. See the Kay Bailey Hutchison Spousal IRA Limit in Publication 590-A.

If neither spouse participated in a retirement plan at work, all of your contributions will be deductible.

Can I contribute to an IRA if I participate in a retirement plan at work?

You can contribute to a traditional or Roth IRA even if you participate in another retirement plan through your employer or business. However, you may not be able to deduct all of your traditional IRA contributions if you or your spouse participates in another retirement plan at work. Roth IRA contributions might be limited if your income exceeds a certain level.

Examples

1. Danny, an unmarried college student earned $3,500 in 2020. Danny can contribute $3,500, the amount of his compensation, to his IRA for 2020. Danny's grandmother can make the contribution on his behalf.
2. John, age 42, has a traditional IRA and a Roth IRA. He can contribute a total of $6,000 to either one or both for 2020.
3. Sarah, age 50, is married with no taxable compensation for 2020. She and her spouse, age 48, reported taxable compensation of $60,000 on their 2020 joint return. Sarah may contribute $7,000 to her IRA for 2020 ($6,000 plus an additional $1,000 contribution for age 50 and over). Her spouse may also contribute $6,000 to an IRA for 2020.

Tax on excess IRA contributions

An excess IRA contribution occurs if you:

- Contribute more than the contribution limit.
- Make a regular IRA contribution for 2019, or earlier, to a traditional IRA at age 70½ or older.
- Make an improper rollover contribution to an IRA.

Excess contributions are taxed at 6% per year for each year the excess amounts remain in the IRA. The tax can't be more than 6% of the combined value of all your IRAs as of the end of the tax year.

To avoid the 6% tax on excess contributions, you must withdraw:

- the excess contributions from your IRA by the due date of your individual income tax return (including extensions); and
- any income earned on the excess contribution.

See Publication 590-A for certain conditions that may allow you to avoid including withdrawals of excess contributions in your gross income.

Related

- Publication 590-A, Contributions to Individual Retirement Arrangements (IRAs)
- Publication 590-B, Distributions from Individual Retirement Arrangements (IRAs)
- IRA Deduction Limits
- Retirement Plans FAQs regarding IRAs
- IRA Year-End Reminders

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